

SENATE No. 1608

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Jacob R. Oliveira

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act relative to physician assistant interstate compact.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	
<i>Jacob R. Oliveira</i>	<i>Hampden, Hampshire and Worcester</i>	
<i>Jason M. Lewis</i>	<i>Fifth Middlesex</i>	<i>2/18/2025</i>
<i>Steven George Xiarhos</i>	<i>5th Barnstable</i>	<i>2/24/2025</i>
<i>Bruce E. Tarr</i>	<i>First Essex and Middlesex</i>	<i>2/26/2025</i>
<i>Barry R. Finegold</i>	<i>Second Essex and Middlesex</i>	<i>4/8/2025</i>
<i>Michael O. Moore</i>	<i>Second Worcester</i>	<i>7/30/2025</i>

SENATE No. 1608

By Mr. Oliveira, a petition (accompanied by bill, Senate, No. 1608) of Jacob R. Oliveira, Jason M. Lewis, Steven George Xiarhos and Bruce E. Tarr for legislation relative to physician assistant interstate compact. Public Health.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act relative to physician assistant interstate compact.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 SECTION 1. The General Laws are hereby amended by inserting after chapter 112A the
2 following chapter:-

3 Chapter 112B. Physician Assistant Licensure Compact.

4 Section 1. In order to strengthen access to medical services, and in recognition of the
5 advances in the delivery of medical services, the participating states of the physician assistant
6 licensure compact have allied in common purpose to develop a comprehensive process that
7 complements the existing authority of state licensing boards to license and discipline physician
8 assistants and seeks to enhance the portability of a license to practice as a physician assistant
9 while safeguarding the safety of patients. This compact allows medical services to be provided
10 by physician assistants, via the mutual recognition of the licensee's qualifying license by other
11 compact participating states. This compact also adopts the prevailing standard for physician
12 assistant licensure and affirms that the practice and delivery of medical services by the physician

assistant occurs where the patient is located at the time of the patient encounter, and therefore requires the physician assistant to be under the jurisdiction of the state licensing board where the patient is located. State licensing boards that participate in this compact retain the jurisdiction to impose adverse action against a compact privilege in that state issued to a physician assistant through the procedures of this compact. The physician assistant licensure compact will alleviate burdens for military families by allowing active duty military personnel and their spouses to obtain a compact privilege based on having an unrestricted license in good standing from a participating state.

Section 2.

As used in this chapter, unless the context requires otherwise, the following words shall have the following meanings:

“Adverse action”, any administrative, civil, equitable, or criminal action permitted by a state’s laws which is imposed by a licensing board or other authority against a physician assistant license or license application or compact privilege such as license denial, censure, revocation, suspension, probation, monitoring of the licensee, or restriction on the licensee’s practice.

“Compact privilege”, the authorization granted by a remote state to allow a licensee from another participating state to practice as a physician assistant to provide medical services and other licensed activity to a patient located in the remote state under the remote state’s laws and regulations.

“Conviction”, a finding by a court that an individual is guilty of a felony or misdemeanor offense through adjudication or entry of a plea of guilt or no contest to the charge by the offender.

“Criminal background check”, the submission of fingerprints or other biometric based information for a license applicant for the purpose of obtaining that applicant’s criminal history record information, as defined in 28 C.F.R. § 20.3(d), from the state’s criminal history record repository as defined in 28 C.F.R. § 20.3(f).

“Data system”, the repository of information about licensees, including but not limited to license status and adverse actions, which is created and administered under the terms of this compact.

“Executive committee”, a group of directors and ex-officio individuals elected or appointed pursuant to paragraph (2) of subsection (f) of section 7.

“Impaired practitioner”, a physician assistant whose practice is adversely affected by health related condition(s) that impact their ability to practice.

“Investigative information”, information, records, or documents received or generated by a licensing board pursuant to an investigation.

“Jurisprudence requirement”, the assessment of an individual’s knowledge of the laws and rules governing the practice of a physician assistant in a state.

“License”, current authorization by a state, other than authorization pursuant to a compact privilege, for a physician assistant to provide medical services, which would be unlawful without current authorization.

“Licensee”, an individual who holds a license from a state to provide medical services as a physician assistant.

“Licensing board”, any state entity authorized to license and otherwise regulate physician assistants.

“Medical services”, health care services provided for the diagnosis, prevention, treatment, cure or relief of a health condition, injury, or disease, as defined by a state’s laws and regulations.

“Model compact”, the model for the physician assistant licensure compact on file with the Council of State Governments or other entity as designated by the commission.

“Participating state”, a state that has enacted this compact.

“Physician Assistant” means an individual who is licensed as a physician assistant in a state. For purposes of this compact, any other title or status adopted by a state to replace the term “Physician Assistant” shall be deemed synonymous with “physician assistant” and shall confer the same rights and responsibilities to the licensee under the provisions of this compact at the time of its enactment.

“Physician Assistant Licensure Compact Commission”, “Compact Commission”, or “Commission”, the national administrative body created pursuant to subsection (a) of section 7.

“Qualifying license”, an unrestricted license issued by a participating state to provide medical services as a physician assistant.

“Remote state”, a participating state where a licensee who is not licensed as a physician assistant is exercising or seeking to exercise the compact privilege.

75 “Rule”, a regulation promulgated by an entity that has the force and effect of law.

76 “Significant investigative information”, investigative information that a licensing board,
77 after an inquiry or investigation that includes notification and an opportunity for the physician
78 assistant to respond if required by state law, has reason to believe is not groundless and, if
79 proven true, would indicate more than a minor infraction.

80 “State”, any state, commonwealth, district, or territory of the United States.

81 Section 3. (a) To participate in this compact, a participating state shall:

82 (1) license physician assistants;

83 (2) participate in the compact commission’s data system;

84 (3) have a mechanism in place for receiving and investigating complaints against
85 licensees and license applicants;

86 (4) notify the commission, in compliance with the terms of this compact and commission
87 rules, of any adverse action against a licensee or license applicant and the existence of significant
88 investigative information regarding a licensee or license applicant;

89 (5) fully implement a criminal background check requirement, within a time frame
90 established by commission rule, by its licensing board receiving the results of a criminal
91 background check and reporting to the commission whether the license applicant has been
92 granted a license;

93 (6) comply with the rules of the compact commission;

(7) utilize passage of a recognized national exam such as the NCCPA PANCE as a requirement for PA licensure; and

(8) grant the compact privilege to a holder of a qualifying license in a participating state.

(b) Nothing in this compact shall prohibit a participating state from charging a fee for granting the compact privilege.

Section 4. (a) To exercise the compact privilege, a licensee must:

(1) have graduated from a physician assistant program accredited by the Accreditation Review Commission on Education for the Physician Assistant, Inc. or other programs authorized by commission rule;

(2) hold current certification from the National Commission on Certification of Physician Assistants;

(3) have no felony or misdemeanor conviction;

(4) have never had a controlled substance license, permit, or registration suspended or revoked by a state or by the United States Drug Enforcement Administration;

(5) have a unique identifier as determined by commission rule;

(6) hold a qualifying license;

(7) have had no revocation of a license or limitation or restriction on any license currently held due to an adverse action;

(8) if a licensee has had a limitation or restriction on a license or compact privilege due to an adverse action, two years shall have elapsed from the date on which the license or compact privilege is no longer limited or restricted due to the adverse action;

(9) if a compact privilege has been revoked or is limited or restricted in a participating state for conduct that would not be a basis for disciplinary action in a participating state in which the licensee is practicing or applying to practice under a compact privilege, that participating state shall have the discretion not to consider such action as an adverse action requiring the denial or removal of a compact privilege in that state;

(10) notify the compact commission that the licensee is seeking the compact privilege in a remote state;

(11) meet any jurisprudence requirement of a remote state in which the licensee is seeking to practice under the compact privilege and pay any fees applicable to satisfying the jurisprudence requirement; and

(12) report to the commission any adverse action taken by a non-participating state within 30 days after the action is taken.

(b) The compact privilege shall be valid until the expiration or revocation of the qualifying license unless terminated pursuant to an adverse action. The licensee must also comply with all of the requirements of subsection (a) to maintain the compact privilege in a remote state. If the participating state takes adverse action against a qualifying license, the licensee shall lose the compact privilege in any remote state in which the licensee has a compact privilege until all of the following occur:

(1) the license is no longer limited or restricted; and

(2) 2 years have elapsed from the date on which the license is no longer limited or restricted due to the adverse action.

(c) Once a restricted or limited license satisfies the requirements of paragraphs (1) and (2) of subsection (b), the licensee must meet the requirements of subsection (a) to obtain a compact privilege in any remote state.

(d) For each remote state in which a physician assistant seeks authority to prescribe controlled substances, the physician assistant shall satisfy all requirements imposed by such state in granting or renewing such authority.

Section 5. (a) Upon a licensee's application for a compact privilege, the licensee shall identify to the commission the participating state from which the licensee is applying, in accordance with applicable rules adopted by the commission, and subject to the following requirements:

(1) when applying for a compact privilege, the licensee shall provide the commission with the address of the licensee's primary residence and thereafter shall immediately report to the commission any change in the address of the licensee's primary residence; and

(2) when applying for a compact privilege, the licensee shall consent to accept service of process by mail at the licensee's primary residence on file with the commission with respect to any action brought against the licensee by the commission or a participating state, including a subpoena, with respect to any action brought or investigation conducted by the commission or a participating state.

Section 6. (a) A participating state in which a licensee is licensed shall have exclusive power to impose adverse action against the qualifying license issued by that participating state.

(b) In addition to the other powers conferred by state law, a remote state shall have the authority, in accordance with existing state due process law, to do all of the following:

(1) take adverse action against a physician assistant's compact privilege within that state to remove a licensee's compact privilege or take other action necessary under applicable law to protect the health and safety of its citizens;

(2) issue subpoenas for both hearings and investigations that require the attendance and testimony of witnesses as well as the production of evidence. Subpoenas issued by a licensing board in a participating state for the attendance and testimony of witnesses or the production of evidence from another participating state shall be enforced in the latter state by any court of competent jurisdiction, according to the practice and procedure of that court applicable to subpoenas issued in proceedings pending before it. The issuing authority shall pay any witness fees, travel expenses, mileage and other fees required by the service statutes of the state in which the witnesses or evidence are located.

(3) notwithstanding paragraph (2), subpoenas may not be issued by a participating state to gather evidence of conduct in another state that is lawful in that other state for the purpose of taking adverse action against a licensee's compact privilege or application for a compact privilege in that participating state; and

(4) nothing in this compact authorizes a participating state to impose discipline against a physician assistant's compact privilege or to deny an application for a compact privilege in that participating state for the individual's otherwise lawful practice in another state.

(c) For purposes of taking adverse action, the participating state which issued the qualifying license shall give the same priority and effect to reported conduct received from any other participating state as it would if the conduct had occurred within the participating state which issued the qualifying license. In so doing, that participating state shall apply its own state laws to determine appropriate action.

(d) A participating state, if otherwise permitted by state law, may recover from the affected physician assistant the costs of investigations and disposition of cases resulting from any adverse action taken against that physician assistant.

(e) A participating state may take adverse action based on the factual findings of a remote state, provided that the participating state follows its own procedures for taking the adverse action.

(f) (1) In addition to the authority granted to a participating state by its respective state physician assistant laws and regulations or other applicable state law, any participating state may participate with other participating states in joint investigations of licensees.

(2) Participating states shall share any investigative, litigation, or compliance materials in furtherance of any joint or individual investigation initiated under this compact.

(g) If an adverse action is taken against a physician assistant's qualifying license, the physician assistant's compact privilege in all remote states shall be deactivated until 2 years have elapsed after all restrictions have been removed from the state license. All disciplinary orders by the participating state which issued the qualifying license that impose adverse action against a physician assistant's license shall include a statement that the physician assistant's compact privilege is deactivated in all participating states during the pendency of the order.

(h) If any participating state takes adverse action, it promptly shall notify the administrator of the data system.

Section 7. (a) The participating states hereby establish a joint government agency and national administrative body known as the physician assistant licensure compact commission. The commission is an instrumentality of the compact states acting jointly and not an instrumentality of any 1 state. The commission shall come into existence on or after the effective date of the compact as set forth in subsection (a) of section 11.

(b)(1) Each participating state shall have and be limited to 1 delegate selected by that participating state's licensing board or, if the state has more than one licensing board, selected collectively by the participating state's licensing boards.

(2) The delegate shall be:

(i) a current physician assistant, physician or public member of a licensing board or physician assistant council/committee; or

(ii) an administrator of a licensing board.

(3) Any delegate may be removed or suspended from office as provided by the laws of the state from which the delegate is appointed.

(4) The participating state licensing board shall fill any vacancy occurring in the commission within 60 days.

(5) Each delegate shall be entitled to 1 vote on all matters voted on by the commission and shall otherwise have an opportunity to participate in the business and affairs of the commission. A delegate shall vote in person or by such other means as provided in the bylaws.

219 The bylaws may provide for delegates' participation in meetings by telecommunications, video
220 conference, or other means of communication.

221 (6) The commission shall meet at least once during each calendar year. Additional
222 meetings shall be held as set forth in this compact and the bylaws.

223 (7) The commission shall establish by rule a term of office for delegates.

224 (c) The commission shall have the following powers and duties:

225 (1) establish a code of ethics for the commission;

226 (2) establish the fiscal year of the commission;

227 (3) establish fees;

228 (4) establish bylaws;

229 (5) maintain its financial records in accordance with the bylaws;

230 (6) meet and take such actions as are consistent with the provisions of this compact; and
231 the bylaws

232 (7) promulgate rules to facilitate and coordinate implementation and administration of
233 this compact. The rules shall have the force and effect of law and shall be binding in all
234 participating states;

235 (8) bring and prosecute legal proceedings or actions in the name of the commission,
236 provided that the standing of any state licensing board to sue or be sued under applicable law
237 shall not be affected;

238 (9) purchase and maintain insurance and bonds;

239 (10) borrow, accept, or contract for services of personnel, including, but not limited to,
240 employees of a participating state;

241 (11) hire employees and engage contractors, elect or appoint officers, fix compensation,
242 define duties, grant such individuals appropriate authority to carry out the purposes of this
243 compact, and establish the commission's personnel policies and programs relating to conflicts of
244 interest, qualifications of personnel, and other related personnel matters;

245 (12) accept any and all appropriate donations and grants of money, equipment, supplies,
246 materials and services, and receive, utilize and dispose of the same; provided that at all times the
247 commission shall avoid any appearance of impropriety or conflict of interest;

248 (13) lease, purchase, accept appropriate gifts or donations of, or otherwise own, hold,
249 improve or use, any property, real, personal or mixed; provided, that at all times the commission
250 shall avoid any appearance of impropriety;

251 (14) sell, convey, mortgage, pledge, lease, exchange, abandon, or otherwise dispose of
252 any property real, personal, or mixed;

253 (15) establish a budget and make expenditures;

254 (16) borrow money;

255 (17) appoint committees, including standing committees composed of members, state
256 regulators, state legislators or their representatives, and consumer representatives, and such other
257 interested persons as may be designated in this compact and the bylaws;

258 (18) provide and receive information from, and cooperate with, law enforcement
259 agencies;

260 (19) elect a chair, vice chair, secretary and treasurer and such other officers of the
261 commission as provided in the commission's bylaws;

262 (20) reserve for itself, in addition to those reserved exclusively to the commission under
263 the compact, powers that the executive committee may not exercise;

264 (21) approve or disapprove a state's participation in the compact based upon its
265 determination as to whether the state's compact legislation departs in a material manner from the
266 model compact language;

267 (22) prepare and provide to the participating states an annual report; and

268 (23) perform such other functions as may be necessary or appropriate to achieve the
269 purposes of this compact consistent with the state regulation of physician assistant licensure and
270 practice.

271 (d) (1) All meetings of the commission that are not closed pursuant to this subsection
272 shall be open to the public. Notice of public meetings shall be posted on the commission's
273 website at least 30 days prior to the public meeting.

274 (2) Notwithstanding paragraph (1) of subsection (d), the commission may convene a
275 public meeting by providing at least 24 hours prior notice on the commission's website, and any
276 other means as provided in the commission's rules, for any of the reasons it may dispense with
277 notice of proposed rulemaking under subsection (I) of section 9.

278 (3) The commission may convene in a closed, non-public meeting or non-public part of a
279 public meeting to receive legal advice or to discuss:

280 (i) non-compliance of a participating state with its obligations under this compact;

281 (ii) the employment, compensation, discipline or other matters, practices or procedures
282 related to specific employees or other matters related to the commission's internal personnel
283 practices and procedures;

284 (iii) current, threatened, or reasonably anticipated litigation;

285 (iv) negotiation of contracts for the purchase, lease, or sale of goods, services, or real
286 estate;

287 (v) accusing any person of a crime or formally censuring any person;

288 (vi) disclosure of trade secrets or commercial or financial information that is privileged or
289 confidential;

290 (vii) disclosure of information of a personal nature where disclosure would constitute a
291 clearly unwarranted invasion of personal privacy;

292 (viii) disclosure of investigative records compiled for law enforcement purposes;

293 (ix) disclosure of information related to any investigative reports prepared by or on behalf
294 of or for use of the commission or other committee charged with responsibility of investigation
295 or determination of compliance issues pursuant to this compact;

296 (x) legal advice; or

297 (xi) matters specifically exempted from disclosure by federal or participating states’
298 statutes.

299 (4) If a meeting, or portion of a meeting, is closed pursuant to this provision, the chair of
300 the meeting or the chair’s designee shall certify that the meeting or portion of the meeting may
301 be closed and shall reference each relevant exempting provision.

302 (5) The commission shall keep minutes that fully and clearly describe all matters
303 discussed in a meeting and shall provide a full and accurate summary of actions taken, including
304 a description of the views expressed. All documents considered in connection with an action
305 shall be identified in such minutes. All minutes and documents of a closed meeting shall remain
306 under seal, subject to release by a majority vote of the commission or order of a court of
307 competent jurisdiction.

308 (e)(1) The commission shall pay, or provide for the payment of, the reasonable expenses
309 of its establishment, organization, and ongoing activities.

310 (2) The commission may accept any and all appropriate revenue sources, donations, and
311 grants of money, equipment, supplies, materials, and services.

312 (3) The commission may levy on and collect an annual assessment from each
313 participating state and may impose compact privilege fees on licensees of participating states to
314 whom a compact privilege is granted to cover the cost of the operations and activities of the
315 commission and its staff, which must be in a total amount sufficient to cover its annual budget as
316 approved by the commission each year for which revenue is not provided by other sources. The
317 aggregate annual assessment amount levied on participating states shall be allocated based upon
318 a formula to be determined by commission rule.

319 (i) A compact privilege expires when the licensee's qualifying license in the participating
320 state from which the licensee applied for the compact privilege expires.

321 (ii) If the licensee terminates the qualifying license through which the licensee applied for
322 the compact privilege before its scheduled expiration, and the licensee has a qualifying license in
323 another participating state, the licensee shall inform the commission that it is changing to that
324 participating state the participating state through which it applies for a compact privilege and pay
325 to the commission any compact privilege fee required by commission rule.

326 (4) The commission shall not incur obligations of any kind prior to securing the funds
327 adequate to meet the same; nor shall the commission pledge the credit of any of the participating
328 states, except by and with the authority of the participating state.

329 (5) The commission shall keep accurate accounts of all receipts and disbursements. The
330 receipts and disbursements of the commission shall be subject to the financial review and
331 accounting procedures established under its bylaws. All receipts and disbursements of funds
332 handled by the commission shall be subject to an annual financial review by a certified or
333 licensed public accountant, and the report of the financial review shall be included in and
334 become part of the annual report of the commission.

335 (f) (1) The executive committee shall have the power to act on behalf of the commission
336 according to the terms of this compact and commission rules.

337 (2) The executive committee shall be composed of 9 members:

338 (i) 7 voting members who are elected by the commission from the current membership of
339 the commission;

340 (ii) 1 ex-officio, nonvoting member from a recognized national physician assistant
341 professional association; and

342 (iii) 1 ex-officio, nonvoting member from a recognized national physician assistant
343 certification organization.

344 (3) The ex-officio members will be selected by their respective organizations.

345 (4) The commission may remove any member of the executive committee as provided in
346 its bylaws.

347 (5) The executive committee shall meet at least annually.

348 (6) The executive committee shall have the following duties and responsibilities:

349 (i) recommend to the commission changes to the commission's rules or bylaws, changes
350 to this compact legislation, fees to be paid by compact participating states such as annual dues,
351 and any commission compact fee charged to licensees for the compact privilege;

352 (ii) ensure compact administration services are appropriately provided, contractual or
353 otherwise;

354 (iii) prepare and recommend the budget;

355 (iv) maintain financial records on behalf of the commission;

356 (v) monitor compact compliance of participating states and provide compliance reports to
357 the commission;

358 (vi) establish additional committees as necessary;

(vii) exercise the powers and duties of the commission during the interim between commission meetings, except for issuing proposed rulemaking or adopting commission rules or bylaws, or exercising any other powers and duties exclusively reserved to the commission by the commission's rules; and

(viii) perform other duties as provided in the commission's rules or bylaws.

(7) All meetings of the executive committee at which it votes or plans to vote on matters in exercising the powers and duties of the commission shall be open to the public and public notice of such meetings shall be given as public meetings of the commission are given.

(8) The executive committee may convene in a closed, non-public meeting for the same reasons that the commission may convene in a non-public meeting as set forth in paragraph (3) of subsection (d) of section 7 and shall announce the closed meeting as the commission is required to under paragraph (4) of said subsection (d) and keep minutes of the closed meeting as the commission is required to under paragraph

(5) of said subsection (d).

(g)(1) The members, officers, executive director, employees and representatives of the commission shall be immune from suit and liability, both personally and in their official capacity, for any claim for damage to or loss of property or personal injury or other civil liability caused by or arising out of any actual or alleged act, error, or omission that occurred, or that the person against whom the claim is made had a reasonable basis for believing occurred within the scope of commission employment, duties or responsibilities; provided that nothing in this paragraph shall be construed to protect any such person from suit or liability for any damage, loss, injury, or liability caused by the intentional or willful or wanton misconduct of that person.

381 The procurement of insurance of any type by the commission shall not in any way compromise
382 or limit the immunity granted hereunder.

383 (2) The commission shall defend any member, officer, executive director, employee, and
384 representative of the commission in any civil action seeking to impose liability arising out of any
385 actual or alleged act, error, or omission that occurred within the scope of commission
386 employment, duties, or responsibilities, or as determined by the commission that the person
387 against whom the claim is made had a reasonable basis for believing occurred within the scope
388 of commission employment, duties, or responsibilities; provided that nothing herein shall be
389 construed to prohibit that person from retaining their own counsel at their own expense; and
390 provided further, that the actual or alleged act, error, or omission did not result from that
391 person's intentional or willful or wanton misconduct.

392 (3) The commission shall indemnify and hold harmless any member, officer, executive
393 director, employee, and representative of the commission for the amount of any settlement or
394 judgment obtained against that person arising out of any actual or alleged act, error, or omission
395 that occurred within the scope of commission employment, duties, or responsibilities, or that
396 such person had a reasonable basis for believing occurred within the scope of commission
397 employment, duties, or responsibilities, provided that the actual or alleged act, error, or omission
398 did not result from the intentional or willful or wanton misconduct of that person.

399 (4) Venue is proper and judicial proceedings by or against the commission shall be
400 brought solely and exclusively in a court of competent jurisdiction where the principal office of
401 the commission is located. The commission may waive venue and jurisdictional defenses in any
402 proceedings as authorized by commission rules.

(5) Nothing herein shall be construed as a limitation on the liability of any licensee for professional malpractice or misconduct, which shall be governed solely by any other applicable state laws.

(6) Nothing herein shall be construed to designate the venue or jurisdiction to bring actions for alleged acts of malpractice, professional misconduct, negligence, or other such civil action pertaining to the practice of a physician assistant. All such matters shall be determined exclusively by state law other than this compact.

(7) Nothing in this compact shall be interpreted to waive or otherwise abrogate a participating state's state action immunity or state action affirmative defense with respect to antitrust claims under the Sherman Act, Clayton Act, or any other state or federal antitrust or anticompetitive law or regulation.

(8) Nothing in this compact shall be construed to be a waiver of sovereign immunity by the participating states or by the commission.

Section 8. (a) The commission shall provide for the development, maintenance, operation, and utilization of a coordinated data and reporting system containing licensure, adverse action, and the reporting of the existence of significant investigative information on all licensed physician assistants and applicants denied a license in participating states.

(b) Notwithstanding any other state law to the contrary, a participating state shall submit a uniform data set to the data system on all physician assistants to whom this compact is applicable, utilizing a unique identifier as required by the rules of the commission, including:

(1) identifying information;

424 (2) licensure data;

425 (3) adverse actions against a license or compact privilege;

426 (4) any denial of application for licensure, and the reason or reasons for such denial,
427 excluding the reporting of any criminal history record information where prohibited by law;

428 (5) the existence of significant investigative information; and

429 (6) other information that may facilitate the administration of this compact, as determined
430 by the rules of the commission.

431 (c) Significant investigative information pertaining to a licensee in any participating state
432 shall only be available to other participating states.

433 (d) The commission shall promptly notify all participating states of any adverse action
434 taken against a licensee or an individual applying for a license that has been reported to it. This
435 adverse action information shall be available to any other participating state.

436 (e) Participating states contributing information to the data system may, in accordance
437 with state or federal law, designate information that may not be shared with the public without
438 the express permission of the contributing state. Notwithstanding any such designation, such
439 information shall be reported to the commission through the data system.

440 (f) Any information submitted to the data system that is subsequently expunged pursuant
441 to federal law or the laws of the participating state contributing the information shall be removed
442 from the data system upon reporting of such by the participating state to the commission.

(g) The records and information provided to a participating state pursuant to this compact or through the data system, when certified by the commission or an agent thereof, shall constitute the authenticated business records of the commission, and shall be entitled to any associated hearsay exception in any relevant judicial, quasi-judicial or administrative proceedings in a participating state.

Section 9. (a) The commission shall exercise its rulemaking powers pursuant to the criteria in this section and the rules adopted thereunder. Commission rules shall become binding as of the date specified by the commission for each rule.

(b) The commission shall promulgate reasonable rules in order to effectively and efficiently implement and administer this compact and achieve its purposes. A commission rule shall be invalid and not have force or effect only if a court of competent jurisdiction holds that the rule is invalid because the commission exercised its rulemaking authority in a manner that is beyond the scope of the purposes of this compact, or the powers granted hereunder, or based upon another applicable standard of review.

(c) The rules of the commission shall have the force of law in each participating state, provided however that where the rules of the commission conflict with the laws of the participating state that establish the medical services a physician assistant may perform in the participating state, as held by a court of competent jurisdiction, the rules of the commission shall be ineffective in that state to the extent of the conflict.

(d) If a majority of the legislatures of the participating states rejects a commission rule, by enactment of a statute or resolution in the same manner used to adopt this compact within 4

years of the date of adoption of the rule, then such rule shall have no further force and effect in any participating state or to any state applying to participate in the compact.

(e) Commission rules shall be adopted at a regular or special meeting of the commission.

(f) Prior to promulgation and adoption of a final rule or rules by the commission, and at least 30 days in advance of the meeting at which the rule will be considered and voted upon, the commission shall file a notice of proposed rulemaking:

(1) on the website of the commission or other publicly accessible platform;

(2) to persons who have requested notice of the commission's notices of proposed rulemaking; and

(3) in such other ways as the commission may by rule specify.

(g) The notice of proposed rulemaking shall include:

(1) the time, date, and location of the public hearing on the proposed rule and the proposed time, date and location of the meeting in which the proposed rule will be considered and voted upon;

(2) the text of the proposed rule and the reason for the proposed rule;

(3) a request for comments on the proposed rule from any interested person and the date by which written comments must be received; and

(4) the manner in which interested persons may submit notice to the commission of their intention to attend the public hearing or provide any written comments.

(h) Prior to adoption of a proposed rule, the commission shall allow persons to submit written data, facts, opinions, and arguments, which shall be made available to the public.

(i) If the hearing is to be held via electronic means, the commission shall publish the mechanism for access to the electronic hearing.

(1) All persons wishing to be heard at the hearing shall as directed in the notice of proposed rulemaking, not less than 5 business days before the scheduled date of the hearing, notify the commission of their desire to appear and testify at the hearing.

(2) Hearings shall be conducted in a manner providing each person who wishes to comment a fair and reasonable opportunity to comment orally or in writing.

(3) All hearings shall be recorded. A copy of the recording and the written comments, data, facts, opinions, and arguments received in response to the proposed rulemaking shall be made available to a person upon request.

(4) Nothing in this section shall be construed as requiring a separate hearing on each proposed rule. Proposed rules may be grouped for the convenience of the commission at hearings required by this section.

(j) Following the public hearing the commission shall consider all written and oral comments timely received.

(k) The commission shall, by majority vote of all delegates, take final action on the proposed rule and shall determine the effective date of the rule, if adopted, based on the rulemaking record and the full text of the rule.

(1) If adopted, the rule shall be posted on the commission's website.

(2) The commission may adopt changes to the proposed rule provided the changes do not enlarge the original purpose of the proposed rule.

(3) The commission shall provide on its website an explanation of the reasons for substantive changes made to the proposed rule as well as reasons for substantive changes not made that were recommended by commenters.

(4) The commission shall determine a reasonable effective date for the rule. Except for an emergency as provided in subsection (l), the effective date of the rule shall be no sooner than 30 days after the commission issued the notice that it adopted the rule.

(l) Upon determination that an emergency exists, the commission may consider and adopt an emergency rule with 24 hours prior notice, without the opportunity for comment, or hearing, provided that the usual rulemaking procedures provided in this compact and in this section shall be retroactively applied to the rule as soon as reasonably possible, in no event later than 90 days after the effective date of the rule. For the purposes of this provision, an emergency rule is one that must be adopted immediately by the commission in order to:

(1) meet an imminent threat to public health, safety, or welfare;

(2) prevent a loss of commission or participating state funds;

(3) meet a deadline for the promulgation of a commission rule that is established by federal law or rule; or

(4) protect public health and safety.

(m) The commission or an authorized committee of the commission may direct revisions to a previously adopted commission rule for purposes of correcting typographical errors, errors

in format, errors in consistency, or grammatical errors. Public notice of any revisions shall be posted on the website of the commission. The revision shall be subject to challenge by any person for a period of 30 days after posting. The revision may be challenged only on grounds that the revision results in a material change to a rule. A challenge shall be made as set forth in the notice of revisions and delivered to the commission prior to the end of the notice period. If no challenge is made, the revision will take effect without further action. If the revision is challenged, the revision may not take effect without the approval of the commission.

(n) No participating state's rulemaking requirements shall apply under this compact.

Section 10. (a)(1) The executive and judicial branches of state government in each participating state shall enforce this compact and take all actions necessary and appropriate to implement the compact.

(2) Venue is proper and judicial proceedings by or against the commission shall be brought solely and exclusively in a court of competent jurisdiction where the principal office of the commission is located. The commission may waive venue and jurisdictional defenses to the extent it adopts or consents to participate in alternative dispute resolution proceedings. Nothing herein shall affect or limit the selection or propriety of venue in any action against a licensee for professional malpractice, misconduct or any such similar matter.

(3) The commission shall be entitled to receive service of process in any proceeding regarding the enforcement or interpretation of the compact or the commission's rules and shall have standing to intervene in such a proceeding for all purposes. Failure to provide the commission with service of process shall render a judgment or order in such proceeding void as to the commission, this compact, or commission rules.

(b) (1) If the commission determines that a participating state has defaulted in the performance of its obligations or responsibilities under this compact or the commission rules, the commission shall provide written notice to the defaulting state and other participating states. The notice shall describe the default, the proposed means of curing the default and any other action that the commission may take and shall offer remedial training and specific technical assistance regarding the default.

(2) If a state in default fails to cure the default, the defaulting state may be terminated from this compact upon an affirmative vote of a majority of the delegates of the participating states, and all rights, privileges and benefits conferred by this compact upon such state may be terminated on the effective date of termination. A cure of the default does not relieve the offending state of obligations or liabilities incurred during the period of default.

(3) Termination of participation in this compact shall be imposed only after all other means of securing compliance have been exhausted. Notice of intent to suspend or terminate shall be given by the commission to the governor, the majority and minority leaders of the defaulting state's legislature, and to the licensing board of each of the participating states.

(4) A state that has been terminated is responsible for all assessments, obligations, and liabilities incurred through the effective date of termination, including obligations that extend beyond the effective date of termination.

(5) The commission shall not bear any costs related to a state that is found to be in default or that has been terminated from this compact, unless agreed upon in writing between the commission and the defaulting state.

(6) The defaulting state may appeal its termination from the compact by the commission by petitioning the U.S. District Court for the District of Columbia or the federal district where the commission has its principal offices. The prevailing member shall be awarded all costs of such litigation, including reasonable attorney's fees.

(7) Upon the termination of a state's participation in the compact, the state shall immediately provide notice to all licensees within that state of such termination:

(i) licensees who have been granted a compact privilege in that state shall retain the compact privilege for 180 days following the effective date of such termination.

(ii) licensees who are licensed in that state who have been granted a compact privilege in a participating state shall retain the compact privilege for 180 days unless the licensee also has a qualifying license in a participating state or obtains a qualifying license in a participating state before the 180-day period ends, in which case the compact privilege shall continue.

(c) (1) Upon request by a participating state, the commission shall attempt to resolve disputes related to this compact that arise among participating states and between participating and non-participating states.

(2) The commission shall promulgate a rule providing for both mediation and binding dispute resolution for disputes as appropriate.

(d)(1) The commission, in the reasonable exercise of its discretion, shall enforce the provisions of this compact and rules of the commission.

(2) If compliance is not secured after all means to secure compliance have been exhausted, by majority vote, the commission may initiate legal action in the United States

District Court for the District of Columbia or the federal district where the commission has its principal offices, against a participating state in default to enforce compliance with the provisions of this compact and the commission's promulgated rules and bylaws. The relief sought may include both injunctive relief and damages. In the event judicial enforcement is necessary, the prevailing party shall be awarded all costs of such litigation, including reasonable attorney's fees.

(3) The remedies herein shall not be the exclusive remedies of the commission. The commission may pursue any other remedies available under federal or state law.

(e)(1) A participating state may initiate legal action against the commission in the U.S. District Court for the District of Columbia or the federal district where the commission has its principal offices to enforce compliance with the provisions of the compact and its rules. The relief sought may include both injunctive relief and damages. In the event judicial enforcement is necessary, the prevailing party shall be awarded all costs of such litigation, including reasonable attorney's fees.

(2) No person other than a participating state shall enforce this compact against the commission.

Section 11. (a) This compact shall come into effect on the date on which this compact statute is enacted into law in the seventh participating state.

(1) On or after the effective date of the compact, the commission shall convene and review the enactment of each of the states that enacted the compact prior to the commission convening referred to as charter participating states, to determine if the statute enacted by each such charter participating state is materially different than the model compact.

(i) a charter participating state whose enactment is found to be materially different from the model compact shall be entitled to the default process set forth in subsection (b) of section 10.

(ii) if any participating state later withdraws from the compact or its participation is terminated, the commission shall remain in existence and the compact shall remain in effect even if the number of participating states should be less than seven. Participating states enacting the compact subsequent to the commission convening shall be subject to the process set forth in paragraph (21) of subsection (c) of section 7 to determine if their enactments are materially different from the model compact and whether they qualify for participation in the compact.

(2) Participating states enacting the compact subsequent to the seven initial charter participating states shall be subject to the process set forth in paragraph (21) of subsection (c) of section 7 to determine if their enactments are materially different from the model compact and whether they qualify for participation in the compact.

(3) All actions taken for the benefit of the commission or in furtherance of the purposes of the administration of the compact prior to the effective date of the compact or the commission coming into existence shall be considered to be actions of the commission unless specifically repudiated by the commission.

(b) Any state that joins this compact shall be subject to the commission's rules and bylaws as they exist on the date on which this compact becomes law in that state. Any rule that has been previously adopted by the commission shall have the full force and effect of law on the day this compact becomes law in that state.

(c) Any participating state may withdraw from this compact by enacting a statute repealing the same.

(1) A participating state's withdrawal shall not take effect until 180 days after enactment of the repealing statute. During this 180 day-period, all compact privileges that were in effect in the withdrawing state and were granted to licensees licensed in the withdrawing state shall remain in effect. If any licensee licensed in the withdrawing state is also licensed in another participating state or obtains a license in another participating state within the 180 days, the licensee's compact privileges in other participating states shall not be affected by the passage of the 180 days.

(2) Withdrawal shall not affect the continuing requirement of the state licensing board of the withdrawing state to comply with the investigative, and adverse action reporting requirements of this compact prior to the effective date of withdrawal.

(3) Upon the enactment of a statute withdrawing a state from this compact, the state shall immediately provide notice of such withdrawal to all licensees within that state. Such withdrawing state shall continue to recognize all licenses granted pursuant to this compact for a minimum of 180 days after the date of such notice of withdrawal.

(d) Nothing contained in this compact shall be construed to invalidate or prevent any physician assistant licensure agreement or other cooperative arrangement between participating states and between a participating state and non-participating state that does not conflict with the provisions of this compact.

(e) This compact may be amended by the participating states. No amendment to this compact shall become effective and binding upon any participating state until it is enacted

654 materially in the same manner into the laws of all participating states as determined by the
655 commission.

656 Section 12. (a) This compact and the commission's rulemaking authority shall be
657 liberally construed so as to effectuate the purposes, and the implementation and administration of
658 the compact. Provisions of the compact expressly authorizing or requiring the promulgation of
659 rules shall not be construed to limit the commission's rulemaking authority solely for those
660 purposes.

661 (b) The provisions of this compact shall be severable and if any phrase, clause, sentence
662 or provision of this compact is held by a court of competent jurisdiction to be contrary to the
663 constitution of any participating state, a state seeking participation in the compact, or of the
664 United States, or the applicability thereof to any government, agency, person or circumstance is
665 held to be unconstitutional by a court of competent jurisdiction, the validity of the remainder of
666 this compact and the applicability thereof to any other government, agency, person or
667 circumstance shall not be affected thereby.

668 (c) Notwithstanding subsection (b) or this subsection, the commission may deny a state's
669 participation in the compact or, in accordance with the requirements of subsection (b) of section
670 (10), terminate a participating state's participation in the compact, if it determines that a
671 constitutional requirement of a participating state is, or would be with respect to a state seeking
672 to participate in the compact, a material departure from the compact. Otherwise, if this compact
673 shall be held to be contrary to the constitution of any participating state, the compact shall
674 remain in full force and effect as to the remaining participating states and in full force and effect
675 as to the participating state affected as to all severable matters.

676 Section 13. (a) Nothing herein prevents the enforcement of any other law of a
677 participating state that is not inconsistent with this compact.

678 (b) Any laws in a participating state in conflict with this compact are superseded to the
679 extent of the conflict.

680 (c) All agreements between the commission and the participating states are binding in
681 accordance with their terms.